

Claude Code — Built-in Tools Reference

All built-in tools available in Claude Code, with category, purpose, and key notes.

#	Tool	Category	Purpose	Key Notes
1	Read	File System	Read file contents with line numbers	Supports text, images, PDFs, .ipynb. Absolute paths only. Required before Edit
2	Write	File System	Create or fully overwrite a file	Used for new files or when Edit can't match
3	Edit	File System	Exact string replacement in a file	old_string must appear exactly once; read-before-edit required
4	MultiEdit	File System	Multiple Edit ops on one file in a single call	Batches edits efficiently; same rules as Edit
5	Glob	File System	Find files by name/pattern	Supports **; results sorted by modified time; cap 100; ignores .gitignore
6	Grep	File System	Search file contents by regex	Wraps ripgrep; skips gitignored files; faster than Bash grep
7	Bash	Execution	Run shell commands in persistent session	2 min timeout (up to 10 min); 30k char output limit; supports run_in_background
8	BashBackground	Execution	Launch a long-running background shell	Used for dev servers, watch builds
9	BashRead	Execution	Read output from a background shell	Works on running or completed background processes
10	BashStop	Execution	Terminate a background shell	Stops a process started by BashBackground
11	WebFetch	Web	Fetch a URL and extract info	Converts HTML → Markdown; uses a small fast model to run the prompt against content
12	WebSearch	Web	Search the web for current info	Returns results with markdown links; US only
13	Task	Agent	Spawn a subagent for complex multi-step work	Agent types: general-purpose, claude-code-guide, statusline-setup, etc. Supports resume
14	TodoWrite	Task Tracking	Create/update a structured task list	States: pending, in_progress, completed

15	TodoRead	Task Tracking	Read the current task list	Used to check progress mid-session
16	SlashCommand	Commands	Execute a slash command programmatically	e.g. <code>/compact</code> , <code>/clear</code> , <code>/memory</code> , <code>/schedule</code>
17	Computer	Computer Use	Screenshot + mouse/keyboard control	Beta; requires opt-in; Pro/Max plans; available in Cowork + Claude Code

Rule of Thumb

Claude Code prefers built-in tools over their Bash equivalents:

Instead of (Bash)	Use (Built-in)
<code>cat file.txt</code>	Read
<code>grep pattern files</code>	Grep
<code>find . -name "*.ts"</code>	Glob

Built-ins offer better output formatting, line numbers, permission flows, and hook integration.

Bash is reserved for: test runs, builds, git operations, and anything with no built-in equivalent.

Hook-Friendly Tool Names

Use these exact names in `allowedTools` , `disallowedTools` , and hook `matcher` fields:

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Read, Write, Edit, MultiEdit, Glob, Grep
Bash, BashBackground, BashRead, BashStop
WebFetch, WebSearch
Task
TodoWrite, TodoRead
SlashCommand
Computer
```

MCP tools follow the pattern: `mcp_{server_name}_{tool_name}`

Use regex like `mcp_github_.*` to match all tools from a specific server.

Hook type Values

type	Runs where	Best for	Can block?
command	Local shell	Linting, formatting, guards	✔ Yes
http	Remote endpoint	Team APIs, audit logging	✔ Yes
prompt	Claude model	Semantic evaluation, task checks	✔ Yes
mcp_tool	MCP server	Reusing existing MCP logic	✔ Yes

agent	Subagent (experimental)	Deep multi-tool verification	 Yes
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Source: Anthropic Claude Code Docs — <https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/claude-code/overview>